



RAILS PLUG-INS

Making Site Development Easy!

This article is a tutorial on how to use Rails plug-ins for pagination, authentication and file attachments. It is aimed at readers with a basic knowledge of Ruby on Rails programming.

A plug-in is a wonderful way to package a frequently implemented solution to a common problem and reuse the code. In case you had to build a blogging application, you could use a blog plug-in, an authentication plug-in, an image-upload plug-in, a comments plug-in and a ratings plug-in. Plug-ins make it super simple to create an application, and save a lot of effort, which in turn, allows you to focus on the user interaction, security and testing.

In this article, we will discuss some of the plug-ins that made our life easy while building Foodlets.in, a visual guide for restaurant food.

For the purpose of this article, let's build a basic events-management application on Rails version 2.3.8. This app would have the *Event* and the *User* models. We shall add in features like user authentication, Facebook Connect, pagination for listing events, image attachment and the ability to use jQuery in place of the default libraries. For your

reference, we have made the source code of this app available on GitHub: <https://github.com/gnaroji/Events-Application>.

To create a new Rails app, issue the following command:

```
rails events
cd events
```

Let's use a scaffold to get started:

```
script/generate scaffold Event title:string description:string
start_date:date end_date:date user_id:integer
```

And here's another scaffold for the *User* model:

```
script/generate scaffold user login:string email:string
persistence_token:string crypt_password:string password_
salt:string
```